

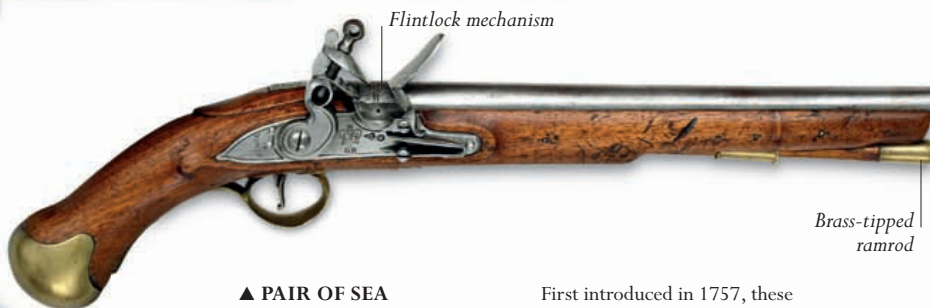
▼ JACKET

Date c.1800

Origin England

Material Linen

A sailor's jacket was short with no tails, and usually blue. Sailors often bought material or clothes from the same outfitter or from the ship's purser, so there was considerable uniformity in their appearance.



▲ PAIR OF SEA SERVICE PISTOLS

Date c.1790

Origin England

Weight 1.1kg (2½lb)

Barrel 30cm (12in)

Calibre .56in

First introduced in 1757, these pistols are of the Pattern 1757/1777 type. Pistols issued to sailors were normally fired only once – in the initial attack or as a last resort. The pistol's brass butt could also be used as a club.

◀ SHIRT AND NECK CLOTH

Date c.1800

Origin England

Material Linen

A checked shirt and neck cloth were the hallmarks of a Royal Navy seaman. The neck cloth could double as a bandanna tied around the head to keep sweat out of the eyes.

NECK CLOTH

Smooth shaft to avoid tangling in netting and rigging

▶ BOARDING PIKE

Date c.1800

Origin England

Weight 3kg (6½lb)

Length 2.4m (8ft)

Pikes were kept in a rack on the main deck. They were handy weapons in the mêlée of confused fighting that ensued when a ship was boarded.

◀ BUCKLED SHOES

Date c.1800

Origin England

Material Leather

Although sailors went barefoot much of the time on board, they would put on their best pair of shoes for the captain's inspection and church service on Sunday.



▲ BELT

Date c.1800

Origin England

Material Leather

To keep his cotton-weave trousers in place, a seaman usually wore a simple, wide, black leather belt with a brass buckle.

Buckle and strap fastening

Shoes issued in standard sizes

